CSCI 360 · COLLEGE OF CHARLESTON · FALL 2026 · THREAT MODEL REPORT

Visual Studio Code

Generated: November 13, 2026 · STRIDE Methodology · Dr. Tony Morelli

4	2
TOTAL THREATS	HIGH RISK
2	0
MEDIUM RISK	LOW RISK

SYSTEM OVERVIEW

VS Code lets developers edit and debug code in local or remote workspaces. This model focuses on the remote web workbench and the files and session data it handles.

ASSETS (3)

Remote Connection Token

SECRET

Remote Workspace Files

CONFIDENTIAL

Remote Workbench Navigation URLs

PUBLIC

ENTRY POINTS (3)

Browser requests and headers to the remote server

UNTRUSTED

Webview requests for remote files

UNTRUSTED

Client supplied x-forwarded-prefix header

UNTRUSTED

IDENTIFIED THREATS: SORTED BY RISK SCORE

(RISK SCORE = LIKELIHOOD × IMPACT, SCALE 1-9)

S

SPOOFING

6
HIGH RISK

Asset: Remote Connection Token (Secret) → via Browser requests and headers to the remote server (Untrusted)

Likelihood: **Med** · Impact: **High** · Score: **6**

✓ *src/vs/server/node/serverConnectionToken.ts validates connection tokens. Protect the token from theft with the workbench content security policy in src/vs/server/node/webClientServer.ts; a stolen valid token could still be reused.*

I

INFO DISCLOSURE

6
HIGH RISK

Asset: Remote Connection Token (Secret) → via Browser requests and headers to the remote server (Untrusted)

Likelihood: **Med** · Impact: **High** · Score: **6**

✓ *The content security policy in src/vs/server/node/webClientServer.ts restricts scripts that could read the browser token. Avoid exposing token values in logs or page content.*

T

TAMPERING

4
MED RISK

Asset: Remote Workbench Navigation URLs (Public) → via Client supplied x-forwarded-prefix header (Untrusted)

Likelihood: **Med** · Impact: **Med** · Score: **4**

✓ *src/vs/server/node/webClientServer.ts validates the decoded forwarded base path. A trusted proxy should remove client supplied x-forwarded-prefix values and set its own.*

INFO DISCLOSURE 3

Asset: Remote Workspace Files (Confidential) → via Webview requests for remote files (Untrusted) MED RISK

Likelihood: **Low** · Impact: **High** · Score: **3**

✓ *src/vs/workbench/contrib/webview/browser/resourceLoading.ts checks requested files against allowed webview resource roots. Normalize and authorize the exact path that is loaded*

RISK SCORE LEGEND

6–9 HIGH RISK

3–5 MEDIUM RISK

1–2 LOW RISK

Score = Likelihood × Impact where Low=1, Med=2, High=3. Maximum score is 9 (High × High). Minimum tracked score is 1.

METHODOLOGY: STRIDE (Spoofing · Tampering · Repudiation · Information Disclosure · Denial of Service · Elevation of Privilege)
TOOL: CSCI 360 Interactive Threat Modeler · College of Charleston · Dr. Tony Morelli · Fall 2026
NOTE: This model reflects the information entered. Threat modeling is an iterative process: revisit this model as the system evolves.